

Shop and Ship let you pay the customs duties online once the package clears customs. If you don't pay online, it'll go straight ahead and send the package to your place, allowing you to pay cash on delivery.

Borderlinx is similar, but without the signup fee, but includes the import duty in the price. It also allows you to consolidate your orders, which can reduce the price of shipping a little.

No space for manual imports

Manual imports are still the preferred mode of receiving and sending goods in remote locations and more dilapidated regions with a lack of infrastructure. The growing benefits brought about by easier data packages and net connections have however benefitted both types of traders.

Cities and villages are connected like never before, and there are many learning the benefits of importing online, except those still in binds about import duties function and how bulk products can be transported.

In the case of Amazon's Global Store, you don't need to do any of that. Other service providers also cannot tell you how much you'll be charged for import duties until your package gets cleared. Companies like Amazon will display an approximate import duty on the product page itself, along with shipping costs.

You may receive a refund from Amazon in case the actual duty charged on the product is less than the deposit, which is often the case.

Many critics of international systems would argue that local online retailers do offer certain perks. When adding for prices along with VAT, shipping and so on would cost more for certain products than say buying through eBay India.

You should also note that when you manually import through US-based online stores, buyers are liable to pay sales tax depending on the state where the product is being shipped, which will vary based on your virtual address. This doesn't apply to some services such as Amazon Global Store.

Dealing with importing perils

Online retail specifically has certain pitfalls associated with setting up, designing, creating, hosting, securing and maintaining virtual channels which may not always be a simple task, especially when dealing with large and growing sales volumes.

Companies also deal with rising logistics costs and storage costs for warehousing goods, dealing with returns and staffing for these tasks.